



Anand Lal Shimpi

This name is synonymous with hardware components reviewers. Anand Lal Shimpi started reviewing hard-



ware components from an age of 15. How about these figures from a CNN profile on Anand Shimpi: If just 1% of AnandTech's monthly visitors were guided to a \$300 purchase, that would amount to more than \$60 million in yearly sales – this was in 1999, when he was just 17. His web site Anandtech.com is a respected name in the hardware components circles.



HyperTransport

HyperTransport in the simplest terms is a high speed interconnection link between processors or processors and chipsets. It is a bus that was created in 2001 by a consortium of which NVIDIA, AMD and Apple are a part. The main function is to provide a high bandwidth and low latency, point-to-point interconnect with the ability to read and write at the same time. Back in 2001, the maximum bi-directional bandwidth was 12.8 GBps to the present avatar HyperTransport 3.1 which supports 51.2 GBps. The HyperTransport (HT) bus has many interesting features in its present form such as Link splitting – which allows each HT link to be split into two and Hot Plugging – which allows HT devices to be installed or removed with the bus still running in the background.



Computex2011

If there is one event which both hardcore component-junkies as well as manufacturers look forward to, it has got to be Computex, which happens annually in Taipei sometime in June. Here are the stats from this year: 5 days, 125,000 attendees, 1,800 exhibitors, 5,300



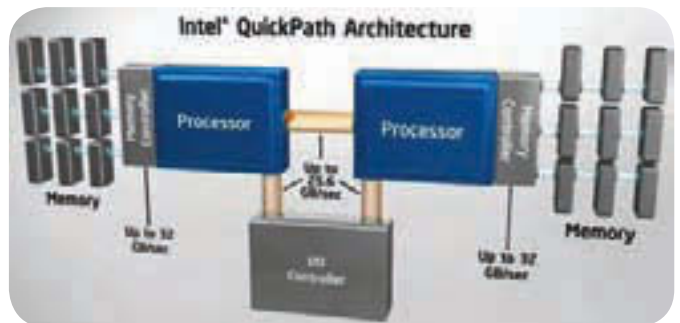
booths, 10,000 plus hardware ICT products!! Many flagship products from many companies are launched here and you also get to see those quirky concept designs such as the Danshui concept board that is seen above.



Quick Path Interface

Intel's Quick Path Interface is a high speed point-to-point link between the processor and the chipset supporting a high degree of parallel movement of data. It was

first introduced in 2008 for the Intel Core -7-9xx processors on the X58 chipset. Its bi-directional bandwidth is 25.6 GB/s. It supports 3 channel memory and 2 x16 combinations for PCIe 2.0 slots. Intel just introduced the QPI 1.1 this year with some improvements.



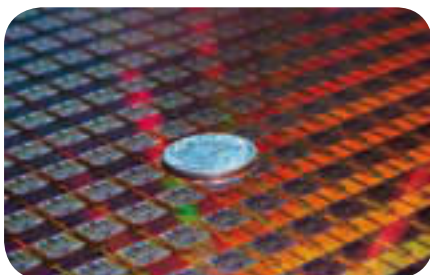
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These are the number of form factors a motherboard can sport based on the use cases. The popular ones we know are ATX, XL-ATX, E-ATX, MicroATX, Mini ITX, but there are many many other form factors such as DTX, NLX, BTX, LPX, etc each having a different area of use.



Intel

From its first commercially available microprocessor - the 4004 to the present day Core i7-3960X, Intel has raised the bar with each year, sticking religiously to the Moore's law. Tick-tock is a terminology popularised by Intel in the tech circles and it does not mean the sound of a clock. Apart from making the fastest desktop processors, Intel also has exhaustive research labs conducting R&D across various disciplines.



Kingston

A name quite popular as far as memory goes, Kingston is a US based company founded by two Taiwanese men - John Tu and David Sun. As far as pure numbers go, it is the number 1 producer of DRAM memory modules

and USB drives. Couple of years ago it got into the SSD market and its HyperX line of SSDs are super impressive. Also this is the only company that we have seen in India, that markets its SSDs on bus stands, communicating about such a niche product to the masses, which is quite laudable.

